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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title:		TAGURABONG: THE TRADITIONAL HARVEST RITUAL PRACTICES OF THE LOCAL FOLKS AT TAPAZ, CAPIZ, PHILIPPINES
Proponent Name:	Ronilo G. Berondo	
Academic Rank:	Associate Professor I	
Co-Authors (with academic rank):		
Campus/Satellite College/Address:	Tapaz Satellite College	
Telephone/Cell Phone/Fax Number:	09979788107	
E-mail Address:	rberondo94@gmail.com	

Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation	
Municipality/City:	Tapaz
Province:	Capiz
Region:	VI

(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>	Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
Research:	Development:						
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing						
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization						

(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization

(9) Rationale (State the research problem and significance of the project to the current needs of the country. The proposal should justify resource expenditure. A typical justification would include a brief introduction, a general statement concerning the historical basis for R & D and, thrusts being
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addressed, utilization of the expected output and the impact information generated will have on science, the target users and the country.)

Traditional harvest practices served as gateways into the cultural identity and social dynamics of the local community. It could contribute to the preservation and promotion of intangible cultural heritage, fostering a deeper appreciation of diverse traditions specifically on farming practices of the local folks (Balogbog, 2020).

In Tapaz, Capiz Philippines, every local community possessed unique rituals and practices that were deeply intertwined with their beliefs, culture, and ecological environment. Monderondo's (2014) study revealed that traditional harvest practices exemplified the farming practices of the local folks in Panay Island in enhancing continuous bountiful harvests. This was also true for the local people of Santa Ana, Tapaz, Capiz, where locals performed the harvest rituals known as *Tagurabong*.

Tagurabong is one of the exceptional harvest ritual practices of the Tapaznons. This time-honored harvest ritual practices had been faithfully passed down through generations within families and continued to be flourished and cherished by the local people. Regenerating the culture is essential. It links us to the past, a reflection of our identity, and a source of inspiration for future generations. However, despite the increasing interest among researchers in documenting harvest rituals, practices and traditions, there are still notable dearth of information about *Tagurabong* in Tapaz, Capiz.

This study will be conducted to document the traditional harvest practices of *Tagurabong* in Santa Ana, Tapaz, Capiz. This triggered the interest of the researcher as an appreciation of their unique local cultural heritage.

(9-A) Project Description (Discuss the project strategy and plan of action of the project. It should also describe the technical procedures and other works needed to carry out the project objectives. The relationship between the project input and activities should be explained clearly in this section. Projects similar/related to the proposed project should be mentioned.)

The researcher will purposively select four (4) key informants to represent the local folks in Sta. Ana, Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. The selection of the informants will be guided by the criteria of Forero et al. (2018) on the three-generation test, which aimed to triangulate the data and capture insights from different age groups. The informants will be chosen based on their relevance and ability to provide valuable perspectives on the traditional harvest practices of *Tagurabong*. The researcher intends to employ various methods to collect information for the study, including fieldwork, observations, interviews with key informants, and examination of documents, photographs, and videos. Once all the data is gathered, it will be transcribed verbatim, meaning it will be written down exactly as it was spoken or observed. Following this, the researcher will analyze the data using the general inductive approach introduced by Thomas in 2006. This method involves identifying patterns and themes within the data and interpreting them to form conclusions. The researcher will seek out recurring concepts such as patterns, trends, or common themes, and then organize them thematically to group related ideas together.

(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem (for Social Sciences) (Statement of the specific purpose to address the problem areas of the project.)

This study aims to document *Tagurabong*, the traditional harvest practices at Santa Ana, Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. Specifically, it seeks answer to the following questions:

1. What knowledge do local folks have about *Tagurabong*?
2. What are the essential elements needed to conduct *Tagurabong*?
3. Why do local folks celebrate *Tagurabong*?
4. How do local folks perform *Tagurabong*?

(11) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework (Include concepts, theories and variables that indicate relevant relationships to be tested.

This study draws on the theory of cultural ecology proposed by Steward (1955 in Nguyen, 2020). It explores the dynamic relationship between society and its environment, emphasizing how

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cultural practices and beliefs are influenced by the ecological context in which they occur. Cultural practices, including agricultural rituals, traditions and practices are influenced by the natural environment and how societies adapt to it.

This present study is also anchored on Rappaport's (1967 in Pesonen, 2022) proposition on ritual practices and cultural performances. He explores the significance of rituals and performances in reinforcing cultural values, maintaining social cohesion, and fostering a sense of identity among community members.

Futhermore, this study is supported by Geertz (1973 in Dzhulay, 2023). He introduced the concept of thick description in his work entitled: the interpretation of culture. Understanding culture requires a detailed and nuanced description of its practices, symbols, and meanings.

Moreover, cultural ecology helps to explore on *Tagurabong* and its intricate relationship between the local community and the ecological environment. Ritual practices and cultural performances aid to understand the significance of *Tagurabong* as a ritual celebration reinforce cultural values. The interpretation of culture sheds light on understanding culture through a detailed and nuanced description of its practices, symbols, and meanings. The celebration of *Tagurabong* may be viewed as a ritual performance through which the local folks reaffirm their connection to the land, express gratitude to their ancestors and deities, and reinforce the social bonds within the community.

(12) Review of Literature (Related researchers/activities that have been conducted. State-of –the-art of current technology / information from which the project proposal will take-off).

Traditional farming in local communities has also been shown to support the cultural and biological diversity that is also attractive to tourists. Consequently, traditional farming offers a mechanism to stimulate and support local cultural- and eco-tourism that accounts for 15–20% world tourism and thus could significantly contribute to local and national economies. Recognizing the adverse impact of mass tourism on vulnerable local social-ecological systems, much attention is drawn to eco-friendly tourism to minimize the common negative impact of tourism and increase the overall benefits for the communities (Ba, 2018).

The traditional farming practices and their support of bio-cultural diversity and ecotourism has led to the call for wide variety of social-ecological systems to generate more contextualized understandings with respect to the various specific areas where it is applied. Additionally, while some scholars urge the need to promote ecotourism to counteract the negative impact of tourism on local areas, few studies examine the link between traditional farming and sustainability in modern mountain areas (Cui, 2018).

According to Hastuti and Sumarmi (2017), the traditional harvest rituals are often understood as a system of cultural construction of symbolic communication. Rituals are often practiced through verbal and non-verbal as well as actions expressed in various media. He proposes models of rituals: ceremony, liturgy, magic, and celebration. Traditional rituals are social activities that involve the community in working together to achieve common safety goals.

Consequently, Das et al. (2020) posited that traditional ritual is one form of realization of a form of culture in the form of a pattern of patterned behavior activities of humans in the community or often called the social system. Furthermore, describes rituals that are basic to the social act of humanity. This social system consists of human activities that interact from time to time and always follow certain patterns based on customary behavior. In essence, the traditional ritual contains not only human activities that are symbolically oriented with nature and supernatural powers, but behind that every ceremony is the embodiment of ideas and aspirations (the will). The idea and the will contain knowledge, values, beliefs, rules that relate human relationships to others, human relationships with their natural environment, and to the supernatural world. Observing these views, it is understood that rituals are associated with voluntary performances with community organized patterns of patterned behavior (based on custom).

In the same vein, Utomo et al. (2020) described ritual as one way to communicate. Realizing that the ritual as one way in communicating, then the term ritual communication emerged. The term of ritual communication was first proposed. He mentioned that "In a ritual definition, communication is linked to terms such as" sharing "," participation "," association "," fellowship ", and" the possession of a common faith ". Furthermore, he added in the ritual view, communication is not directly directed to disseminate the message in a space, but rather the maintenance of a community at a time.

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Communication patterns built in view of the ritual is sacred ceremony (ceremonial sacred/holy) where everyone together and assembled (fellowship and commonality).

In line with Bisht et al. (2020) that explains the pattern of communication in ritual perspective is not that the sender sends a message to the recipient, but as a sacred ceremony in which everyone shares a common part in fellowship and assembly as well as performing the banquet. In the view of ritual, the more important is the community togetherness in doing prayer and ceremonial. Furthermore, he describes communication with the unseen world cannot be implemented by means of communication in the form of everyday language but with symbols that serve as a medium of communication believed to have magical or magical values with the aim can be established communication that can be interconnected.

Ba et al. (2023) study revealed the continuation of traditional farming practices guided by the traditional farming calendar and characterized by mixed cropping, inter cropping, and rotation, which optimized the use of limited arable lands in the area. These practices also contributed to maximizing and securing local food supply and maintaining endemic crop varieties. The results suggested that traditional farming offered a way to overcome the limitation of modern agriculture and support ecotourism as a sustainable alternative to mass tourism, by preserving crop diversity, social institutions, and cultural traditions, and stabilizing the local environment. Furthermore, our findings showed that traditional farming, in keeping with local capacity, was adaptable to the impacts of climate change. In the last two decades, a returning tide of young residents and retired people involved in traditional farming might play a key role in the slowing down of the loss of agricultural lands in Wutai, influenced by the fashion of healthy foods and environments, as well as development of local ecotourism industry. Learned from this study, while there would be some opportunity for traditional farming to be recognized as one of the key components to promote the sustainable development of indigenous villages in mountain areas, more policy incentives might be considered.

In Murphy's (2017) study, the transverse harvest knife, also commonly called the finger or finger-bladed knife, has been utilized by rice farmers in southeast Asia for many centuries. The finger knife persisted in many traditional cultures long after the introduction of the sickle, a tool which provided farmers with the means to execute a much faster harvest.

Hastuti and Sumarmi (2017) study, showed that majority of Banjar tribe communities work as farmers and convert to Islam. Banjar tribal society called the rice farming system in terms bahuma. Ritual activities in bahuma intended to ask to God to harvest abundant and avoided from crop failures. This study aims to describe rituals performed in the Banjar tribe farmers bahuma activities. The method used in this research is descriptive qualitative. Data collection was done by observation, interview, documentation, and literature study. Data were analyzed using Miles and Huberman interactive model. The research findings indicate that farmers Banjarese perform rituals during the process: manaradak (seeding rice), batanam (planting rice in paddy), mangatam (harvest), and imbah katam (after the harvest).

The traditional harvest practices in the Philippines provides valuable insights into the cultural significance and preservation of indigenous agricultural traditions. Studies conducted in different regions of the country shed light on the importance of documenting and understanding traditional harvest practices for the preservation of cultural heritage.

In Biclar et al. (2018) study on traditional harvest festivals in the Philippines highlights the deep connection between agricultural practices and cultural identity. These festivals often involve elaborate rituals, dances, and feasts to celebrate the bountiful harvest and express gratitude to nature and ancestral spirits.

Ramirez (2016) study highlighted indigenous knowledge systems and practices (IKSP) as significant traditional agricultural techniques for sustainable resource management. It provides frameworks for human interaction and adaptation to the environment, ensuring the satisfaction of basic needs and the long-term sustainability of resources.

Berondo's (2023) study documented the cultural farming ritual practices and beliefs of Panay Bukidnon in Tapaz, Capiz. His study highlighted the holistic relationship between humans and the environment, the role of ancestral spirits in agricultural activities, and the transmission of knowledge from one generation to another. Drawing upon this work can provide a broader understanding of the cultural and spiritual dimensions of *Tagurabong*.

The traditional agricultural practices and indigenous knowledge in the Philippines were emphasized in the study conducted by Mantikayan and Abas (2019) they stressed the importance of

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preserving and revitalizing traditional farming methods. They further stated that the traditional practices, including harvest rituals and ceremonies, are closely tied to sustainable agriculture and the preservation of biodiversity.

A study conducted by Groppo (2019) explores the role of traditional harvest practices in strengthening community resilience and social cohesion among indigenous communities in the Philippines. The research highlights how traditional rituals and celebrations, such as harvest festivals, serve as important occasions for cultural preservation, intergenerational knowledge transfer, and community bonding.

Olapane et al. study (2021) examined the connections between traditional agricultural practices, cultural identity, and food security in indigenous communities. Their research emphasizes the importance of preserving and promoting traditional farming systems to ensure local food sovereignty and resilience against external pressures.

Castro's (2017) study focuses on the role of indigenous rituals and ceremonies in preserving ecological balance and protecting natural resources in the Philippines. Their research highlights how traditional practices, such as harvest rituals, are deeply rooted in indigenous cosmology and belief systems, fostering a harmonious relationship between humans and the environment.

Madrid's (2017) study delved on the cultural significance of harvest rituals in the Visayas region of the Philippines. He discussed how these practices served as important cultural markers and expressions of identity. The research highlights the unique elements of harvest rituals, including music, dance, and offerings, which reflect the distinct cultural traditions of each community.

Tejada et al. (2017) study unveiled the traditional farming practices in the upland areas of Cebu, Philippines and Gunma, Japan during pre-planting, planting, and post planting by identifying the farming methods used; and designing innovative culturally based Ugmad Teaching Model (UTM) that catapulted the use of traditional farm practices into the art of teaching and learning process. This qualitative study utilized a comparative case study design of a typical farming village in Cebu, Philippines and in Gumna, Japan using a narrative analysis. Unstructured questions were used in a one-on-one interview of the research participants. The upland farming practices were significant and interdependent processes necessary in farm production. Both inorganic and organic farming as well as the basic tools were widely used in Village Farm X; while organic farming and high-tech machineries were commonly used in Village Farm Y which enhanced productivity in preserving the environment that resulted in large chasm between the farming cultures of the two villages. As extrapolated in the study, the UTM was derived as a creative and a culturally based teaching strategy to fit in the contextualized and localized teaching in the Outcomes-based Education (OBE) curricula.

(13) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods, duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Methodology

Qualitative research design will be employed in this study. Qualitative research design is a methodological approach used to explore and understand the subjective experiences, meanings, and social contexts of individuals or groups. It focuses on the in-depth exploration and interpretation of people's perspectives, beliefs, behaviors, and interactions, aiming to gain a holistic understanding of the phenomena under investigation (Merriam, 2020; Creswell & Poth, 2018). This study will also use ethnography as a qualitative method. Ethnography is a specific qualitative research method that involves immersing oneself in a particular social group or culture to understand its dynamics, beliefs, practices, and meanings from an insider's perspective (Denzin & Lincoln, 2018; Hammersley & Atkinson, 2019). It emphasizes prolonged engagement and participant observation, where researchers actively participate in the daily lives of the community they study, observe their practices, and interact with them to gain a deep understanding of their culture and traditions.

In the context of this study, the researcher will employ an ethnographic approach to document and record the traditional harvest practices of *Tagurabong* among the local folks in Sta. Ana Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. The researcher will immerse himself within the community for two weeks, conducting informal interviews, and engaging in participant observation. The researcher aims to

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capture the essence and intricacies of *Tagurabong* through the lens of the local folks themselves. This approach will allow the researchers to gather firsthand accounts, observe the rituals and practices in their authentic settings, and document the cultural significance of *Tagurabong* in the lives of the community members. The use of ethnography in this study will facilitate a comprehensive understanding of the traditional harvest practices, ensuring that the voices and perspectives of the local folks will be accurately represented in the documentation process.

Participants

The researchers will purposively select four (4) key informants to represent the local folks in Sta. Ana, Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. The selection of the informants will be guided by the criteria of Forero et al. (2018) on the three-generation test, which aimed to triangulate the data and capture insights from different age groups. The informants will be chosen based on their relevance and ability to provide valuable perspectives on the traditional harvest practices of *Tagurabong*. These key informants were chosen to ensure a diverse representation of the local community and capture a range of perspectives related to *Tagurabong*. By including participants from different generations, the researchers aimed to obtain a comprehensive view of the cultural practices, beliefs, and values associated with the harvest.

Locale of Study

The study will be conducted at Sta. Ana, Tapaz, Capiz for the two (2) executive weeks. Sta. Ana is a barangay in the municipality of Tapaz, in the province of Capiz. Sta. Ana is situated at approximately 11.3154, 122.5402, in the island of Panay. Elevation at these coordinates is estimated at 61.7 meters or 202.4 feet above mean sea level. Sta. Ana shares a common border with the following barangay(s): Camburanan, San Nicolas, San Antonio, San Julian, Candelaria, and Taslan. Its population as determined by the 2020 Census was 1,156. This represented 2.12% of the total population of Tapaz. The household population of Sta. Ana in the 2015 Census was 1,074 broken down into 306 households or an average of 3.51 members per household. According to the 2015 Census, the age group with the highest population in Sta. Ana is 10 to 14, with 116 individuals. Conversely, the age group with the lowest population is 80 and over, with 11 individuals. The population of Sta. Ana grew from 1,032 in 1990 to 1,156 in 2020, an increase of 124 people over the course of 30 years. The latest census figures in 2020 denote a growth rate of 1.56%, or an increase of 82 people, from the previous population of 1,074 in 2015 (PhilAtlas, 2024).

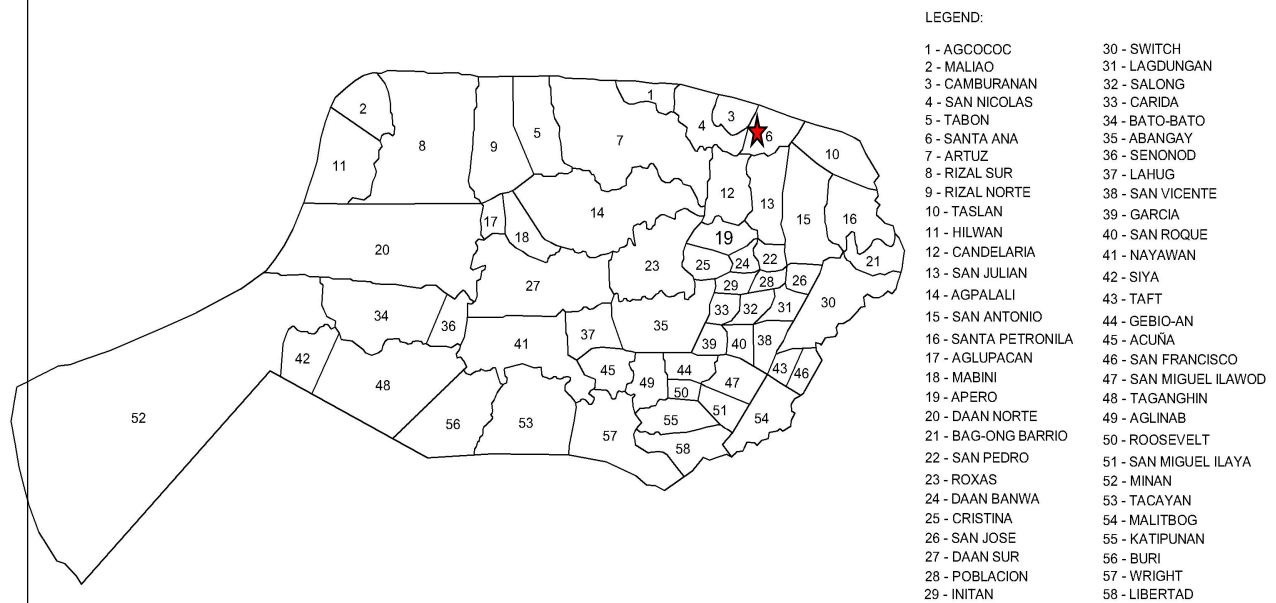


Figure 1. Geographic Information System (GIS) Map of Sta. Ana, Tapaz, Capiz from Berondo (2023)

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(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate in chronological order the task to be undertaken. Use Gantt chart. Below is an example. This can be modified based on your desired Work plan.)

Research Objectives	Year 1											
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sept	Oct	Nov	Dec
1. Preparation and presentation of research proposal												
2. Preparation of checklist/questionnaires for intended data to be gathered												
3. Hiring of data entry staff/enumerators												
4. Distribution, gathering of data and collection of checklist/survey questionnaires on identified areas												
5. Recording, analysis and interpretation of the data gathered												

(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)

- Documentary Video

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Design (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services to be transferred as extension activities)

(16) Targets Beneficiaries (Who the clientele are and what are the expected outcome/effects of the use of the projects output)

- Future researchers
- Extension providers

(17) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role (Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization
Ronilo G. Berondo	Proponent	Social Science

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Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study:				
Program/Project Leader (in hours):				
Program/Project Members (in hours):				
(18) Budgetary Requirement				
SOURCES OF EXPENSES	QUANTITY	UNIT	PRICE PER UNIT	TOTAL
SUPPLIES				
Printer (Epson L3150)	1	pc	9,000	9,000
Digital camera (Canon EOS 600D)	1	pc	18,000	18,000
A4 size bond paper	10	reams	350	3,500
Black and colored inks	4	bottles	300	1,200
Tape measure	5	pcs	50	250
Recording Notebook	1	pc	80	80
Ballpen	10	pc	30	300
SUBTOTAL				32,250.00
Personnel Services (For studies needed the Research Assistant, informant/s, guide)				
Research Assistant	Days	90	500	45,000.00
Travel Allowance	Days	90	150	13,500
SUBTOTAL				58,500.00
TOTAL EXPENSES				90,750.00

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

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(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

Name	:	Ronilo G. Berondo
Date of Birth	:	March 9, 1985
Citizenship	:	Filipino
Gender	:	Male
Civil Status	:	Married
Academic Rank	:	Associate Professor I
Present Station	:	Tapaz Satellite College
Mailing Address	:	San Julian, Tapaz, Capiz
E-mail Address	:	rberondo94@gmail.com
Mobile Number	:	09979788107